

The Amulet of Anthea

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I

The Elemental Court of Glaciem

“Impossible!”, the sharp tone of troubled voices cut through the night like a blade sharper than sound itself. When a small parchment note arrived at the circular building of the Elemental Court of Glaciem in Iceria, the capital city of the ice kingdom, a giant panic erupted amongst the representatives of Altaldis, Electria and Natura, just 3 of the 5 Patron members. But one seat was empty, the seat of the representative of Collossus.

After the sun set, and the full moon shined through the transparent ice in the windows, King Arsus finally stood up and began speaking: *“We should help them.”*, he said. The silence in the court room was finally broken by Lena, Queen of Atlantis and representative of her kingdom: *“But look at those burn marks on the paper.”*, the rest of the court nodded in awe. Because of that reaction Arsus immediately walked up to the middle of the chamber and started delivering his speech: *“When Glaciem was in danger, and our kingdom was in ruins, we were experiencing identical problems. But we did not falter. I saw the rallied forces of Lena and Vision march onto the battlefields and defending my kingdom without questions. Glaciem will not stand still while its ally is in danger, we will not just sit here and wait until the danger reaches us!”*, he shouted.

Judge Glacier announced: *“The King has spoken. I sadly cannot change his decision.”*

When everyone had left the room, Glacier asked Arsus a question: *“Do you think it is wise to go to war, again?”*. Arsus just looked at him, transferring a message without needing to speak.

After those events in the courtroom, and because the administration at that time was way too much, the judge had to write down everything that had happened, or at least the verdict, so he wrote down:

“THE KING SPOKE, AND DECIDED TO ATTACK THE ENEMY.”

And that translates to:

“The king spoke, and decided to attack the enemy.”

It was a tradition to write an extensive document about those events, that tradition evolved into the standard, but judge Glacier decided not to record this specific verdict extensively... and prevent any future backfires from it, a rare decision at that time.

The sun rose; and began it's long journey trough the sky, though it wasn't the only one that was preparing for a journey... Back at the barracks soldiers were preparing for the big cross. The ocean in ALJiVi-World isn't as easy to cross as the ocean on Earth. Inbetween the vast continents that we have there are streches of seas the could be called oceans by humans. The planet ALJiVi-World rests on is giant, at least 100 times bigger than the Sun in the Human Universe. So while the continents are also giant, there are so few of them that the bodies of waters seporating them just are of great scale themselves.

The armies of Glaciem at that time have developed this new kind of ability, walking on water. This may sound like something that only Atlantisians could do, but in reality they did not simply set their foot on water. The soldiers of the ice kingdom created platforms just the size of their feet under them the second they were about to step further forward.

The rallied forces of Glaciem marched trough the ocean on sunset. Crossing most of the Sea of Agnafrosta (*M̥X̊YM̊FX̊+AF̊R̊RX̊ET̊F̊*) at night.

II

The Liberation of Collossus

Sunrise, on the beaches of Collossus a rythmical sound echoed from across the sea.
Thud, thud, thud, thud...

The soldiers and guards of Vulcanus sprinted to the beach as they watched something getting bigger at the horizon, blinding the sun. “No wait, the *thing* is coming closer!” a commander shouted.

As the rythmical sound of footsteps marching in perfect sync got louder across the island, the soldiers wanted to try out their new invention.

A few days beforehand a new invention arose in the army, an invention that could rule the outcomes of the next few generations of battles: the *Spiker*; it had a musket style shape, a long barrel, and a trigger just at the hands. You did not need to reload the Spiker manually; you just simply restock the ammuniton it with your ice powers. You see, the Spiker shoots spikes made out of ice, so to reload it you just form one inside of the chamber, you pull the trigger, and it shoots into the barrel outwarded. You may think: *Why not just do that with your powers too?* But that would be inprecise, you would need to be extremely skilled to do so.

The soldiers of Glaciem raised their Spikers up, with that invention a new job arose in the army. The people wielding the Spiker were called Spikersmen. And as the sun rose even higher all of the Spikersmen on the shore of Collossus raised their weapon up and aimed at the oposing soldiers.

BANG!, the sound echoed trough the island forcing its way though many eardrums. It was a short period, half a second and gone they were, the Vulcanus soldiers.

With the first line already gone the Spikersmen hit hard on the beach, within minutes they had the whole island surrounded in a ring of soldiers all around on each shore, cliff and any border they had with the water. Then they started running towards the capital: *Titanus*.

As the soldiers ran towards the capital in the center of the continental island, they made the ring smaller, which in turn caused a feeling of condensation as the ring got thicker the closer to the center they went. Along the way they made a few shots. Then they arrived at the capital. The Vulcanus soldiers weren't expecting much but they were looking out for any threats.

With that knowledge Arsus commanded his soldiers to go onto the mountains and wait there for his sign. One by one the Glacarian soldiers replaced the red flags with their own. Generals at the feet of the mountains looked up and were surprised by their own flag being removed. Suddenly Arsus lowered his hand and pointed downwards.

All spikersmen suddenly shot a giant dome of spikes straight down the mountains right to the main forum and every area around it. The sound was so loud that it turned into a small shockwave that made clouds start moving to the opposite direction: **BANG!**

A quarter of the soldiers were already to the ground, their fire dying and them disappearing in to the afterlife. Then the soldiers started running down the mountains. Their speed however became too much for them to handle, the soldiers all slipped and started rolling downwards instead. The rest of the fire army had already drawn their blades and jumped to the invading forces. It was a ruthless scene, shots firing, blades clashing, spears breaking, flags burning, soil freezing and burning at the same time. One side of the capital became as warm as the sun, while the other side became as cold as the moon.

As the sides clashed... 2 sounds stood out on the battlefield: a horn and a very sharp flute. The horn whined with a calm calling sound while the flute responded with an ear-piercing sound that cut through the air. The 2 sides were calling each other onto the battlefield, and 2 fellows were about to meet.

Sunset, fire soldiers already weakening in power and their first resistance faltering as the invasion continued around them. They knew it was too late. Then suddenly something shook the ground... At the peak of the highest mountain 2 clashing lights, one blue, one red, created escalating shockwaves that on their turn escalated the battle going on below.

Arsus delivered another blow as Pyrothonis, the fire nation lead general and governor of the colony, flew back. But then the general shot a fireball at Arsus knocking him down as well. While the two were fighting, millions of enslaved Kaltaris arose and broke themselves free from the steel chains. As the battle continued down below the 2 flashing lights on the mountain continued to clash with each other as Arsus and Pyrothonis continued battling above the chaos down below.

"Fancy seeing you here!", Pyrothonis said.
Arsus responded: *"I just wanted to say the same."*

All of the sudden a blue flash hit the general knocking him back onto the ground. *"I knew you would conquer many lands... but why Collossus?"*, he asked. Pyrothonis lunged forward but was quickly knocked back.

Glacarian soldiers made their way onto the mountain... arresting the general as green banners were once again lowered from the posts. Xanji, the king of Collossus, ran to Arsus and began asking questions about the conquest and liberation. Arsus however, was busy making sure everything went to plan: *“Make sure to carry Pyrothonis away to the Prison of Frost. Put everything in our records.”*

Xanji: *“I want to see the one who burnt my kingdom.”*

Arsus: *“That will not be possible, King Zanzi.”*

Xanji: *“Make sure to write my name down correctly...”*

Arsus: *“I’ll make sure Csanghi will be written on the documents.”*

“Recorder! Write the name of their king: <ƧƧXN!”

Xanji: *“That’s not how...”*

III

Imperial Goals

As the sun rose above Iceria, a giant croud gathered at the station $\text{KMRIF } \text{M}^{\dagger}\text{TRNF}$. The king had ordered everyone to come for his speech. The Gliders departed the central station now heading for $\text{ZTFYF } \text{FR}^{\text{c}}\text{MNFIF}^{\text{c}}\text{Z}$, the Palace Plaza.

The doors opened with a hissing sound made from trapped air. In just a few moments the whole forum went from empty to overflowing. Xanji was back at Collossus, so was everyone else of the patron. Arsus however had other plans for Glaciem after he saw what Vulcanus had done.

The people were cheering, unpatiently waiting for what their king had to say. Crowds went silent once the doors opened and Arsus stepped out of the palace onto the balcony.

“An era of war has filled our times...” Xanji started making his way to Glaciem as he noticed Iceria was empty... *“...an era of disunity...”* Xanji heard the sound coming from the plaza as he slammed his hands into the ice. A giant pillar of rock arose breaking trough the frozen continent and launching him over 3 sets of walls onto the plaza, he hid himself quickly behind a pillar as Arsus continued: *“...these times call for desperate measures.”* Silence filled the plaza even more than before, nobody knew what the king was anouncing, but it seemed urgent and important. *“At this day, the 1st of Glacimorn, the first day of this shining year, I am reforming Glaciem into a new nation... a nation of unity, a strong nation...”* Xanji was now deciding in his head if he did hear this correctly, if this was actually happening... *“I am reforming Glaciem into the Moon Empire! With the goal to unite the world!”* Crowds started cheering, soldiers poured in from the doors, standing proudly. The flag of Glaciem, with the white snowflake on blue, was lowered from its post. Xanji watched in surprise as a new flag was risen in the its palce, flying in the wind, a white eagle on blue.

Still surprised by the event, Xanji was running onto his ship, he ordered to message the Patron members, excluding Arsus, to meet back in Titanus. He didn't know what the Moon Empire would do, but leaders do not simply form empires witout reason.

As the stone-wooden ship departed the port of Iceria, Xanji watched the ocean of people flood back into the city, he knew something wasn't right. Empires don't just form, they have a reason, a goal.

Lena saw it the second he came into the chamber, a face as pale as the sun. Vision sat uncomfortably in a chair when Xanji started explaining everything he saw, he spoke for an hour at most with almost no pauses for air. When he finally finished speaking: Lena stood up with both paws pressed onto her mouth, when she finally took in what Xanji just had said, she finally spoke: *"But why would Arsus do something like that?"* Xanji didn't have the answer, all he had was a single scroll of parchment filled with runes. He announced their first task: *"I can't read this piece of useful information without a conversion chart, we need to know how to read runes or we will most certainly never understand their papers."* Lena then responded: *"I still have a few ships docked here, they're made out of black prismarine, we won't be seen during the night."* Xanji nodded, he left the chamber and stared out the balcony on the Thrirapes, the central mountain around which Titanus was built. He couldn't believe it, a friend he fought with that same day created an empire...

Midnight. The New Moon made sure they remained unseen as Xanji, Lena and Vision alongside some soldiers from their respective nations approached the port of Iceria unseen in their black cloaks.

They slowed down fast before they docked fully because they didn't want to make a sound. Vision slipped into the building on the boat and took out a black cloth, he threw it over the ship. Lena quickly jumped into the ice cold water and came out on the other side, she fastened the cloth with a rope and then made her way back to the dock. As the team stepped onto the ice, leaving their ship behind them, they approached a gate. The barrier was massive, and they had no idea how to get inside, as they looked up they noticed a few guards standing on the 2 towers that arose on both sides of the only thing separating them from entering the capital city. Their faces widened in shock as they saw the new flag on the towers, instead of seeing blue flags with white snowflakes on them they only saw white eagles, Xanji wasn't kidding.

Suddenly behind them a noise came from a small cart that was being pulled by a reindeer. They snuck onto the cart unnoticed and hid there until they heard the sound of the massive gates open, silver crashing against ice as the 2 massive slabs of metal slid into the frozen walls. They felt movement as the cart drove inside and the same sound echoed behind them when the gates closed.

Light hit their faces as they stepped out of the cart and watched the city, completely different from what they remembered. The series of small houses next to larger buildings made way for giant blocks flanking both sides of the main channel, fountains everywhere, eagles everywhere, banners of the Moon Empire on almost each wall. They quickly slipped through a door into a building and noticed a staircase leading down below, they were expecting a basement, but they got something way more shocking. Coming out of the hall they saw a street, a street with those same small buildings and those same shops and reindeers they remembered everywhere, but instead of an open

sky there was a ceiling. That ceiling was being supported not only by columns placed in open spaces, but also on those very same buildings. The entire new imperial city was built directly on top of the old one.